cultural productions has also been interrogated (*ibid.*, 60–67; see also Patel 2006: 9–11). Additionally, see *infra* in main text and notes.

12. The Persian-language monographs – two published in Afghanistan and two in Iran – were recently analyzed against the backdrop of these areas' respective nationalisms, emerging over the twentieth century. While the "extra-intellectual" impetuses of these works' authors were brought to the fore, "the cognizance of [such] factors on scholarship … in western-language works" must also be borne in mind (Patel 2017: 144 ff.). Further, see Thomas (2018: 9 and *passim*) for a discussion of "the Ghurid interlude," coined by Bosworth (1968b: 166).
13. See de Bruijn 1983, cited *supra* in notes (my emphasis).
14. Burbank and Cooper 2010: 4, 8, 12–13, 15, 17–18.
15. Meisami 1993: 268. See also Hardy 1960: 113–118; Sarkar 1977: 28; Nizami 1983: 48–49; Siddiqui 2010, esp. 2–8. See also Auer 2012: 3ff.
16. For the early eighth-century Umayyad incursions into Sindh and their usages in colonial and later historiography, see Inden 2000: esp. 17 and notes. Also, while Asif (2016: 2ff.) discussed *Chach-nama*'s (*c.* 1226 CE) description of these events as the dubiously grand "beginnings" of Islam in South Asia, the campaigns of Mahmud of Ghazna into northern India have also commanded attention as originary in public and intellectual cultures over the last millennium (cf. Anooshahr 2009: 1–3).
17. See, e.g., Sen (2017) for analysis of Muhammad Ghulam Husain Tabatabai's *Sair al-Mutakhirin* (1779–80). For the earlier period of the sixteenth century, Anooshahr (2009: 23–26) intriguingly posited that the future emperor Babur's motivations for (and his perception of) his own campaigns into India were deeply colored by his thorough familiarity with Mahmud Ghaznavi's raids into the north Indian *duab* as gleaned from the works of 'Utbi and Juzjani. These interpretations of events and processes form a striking contrast with Bronson's (1988: 208–209) contemporary historicist view of northern India as "… one of the world's great civilized traditions [that was] within raiding range of unusually effective *barbarians*" (my emphasis) – cf. *infra* in main text and notes.
18. For a relatively recent example, see Flood's *Objects of Translation* (2009), whose timespan encompassed the ninth through the early thirteenth centuries, and the historical geographies of western Afghanistan through the Panjab and the Himalayan foothills, as well as the north Indian plains. The author stated: "… the centuries covered by this book have occupied center stage in colonial and nationalist constructions of a past that has been cast as a perpetual confrontation between Muslim invaders and Hindu resisters, a Manichean dyad that has structured and constrained the history of the region for almost a millennium" (*ibid.*, 2) – essentially reiterating the tautological inertia the current work is attempting to interrupt.
19. Cf. Amin 2002: 30, again with slight modification in the form of adducing the historical process of cultural transformation, for the purposes of this Introduction and the broader aims of these volumes.
20. Applied much in the same sense as Amin (cited *supra*), i.e., "to attempt, to try to do, effect, accomplish, or make (anything difficult)," in use as of the seventeenth century. Cf. *OED*, "essay."